

Stroke: Remember FAST

Sudden neurological symptoms are an emergency.

F - Face

- Ask the person to smile. Look for sudden facial drooping or unevenness.

A - Arms

- Ask them to raise both arms. One arm may drift downward or feel weak or numb.

S - Speech

- Listen for slurred, confused or unusual speech. Ask them to repeat a simple sentence.

T - Time

- Call emergency services immediately. Record when the person was last known well.

Other sudden signs

- Vision loss, severe imbalance, numbness, confusion or a sudden severe headache can also occur.
- Symptoms that disappear can still represent a transient ischemic attack and need urgent assessment.

Urgent warning

In Qatar, call 999 immediately for possible stroke. Do not wait for symptoms to improve.